GOVERNMENT OF INDIA - SCHOLARSHIP NOTIFICATION

DEPARTMENT OF HIGHER EDUCATION & SOCIAL WELFARE
NOTIFICATION NO: EDN/SCH/2026-8840
SCHEME: NATIONAL MERIT-CUM-MEANS SCHOLARSHIP SCHEME (NMMSS) 2026-27

1. OBJECTIVE AND PURPOSE:
The objective of the scheme is to award scholarships to meritorious students of economically weaker sections to arrest their drop-out at class VIII and encourage them to continue their education at secondary stage.

2. IMPORTANT DATES & TIMELINES:
- Portal Opening Date: October 15, 2026
- Last Date for Online Application Submission: November 30, 2026
- Institution Level Verification Deadline: December 15, 2026
- State Nodal Officer Verification Deadline: December 31, 2026
- State-level Examination Date: January 18, 2027

3. ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA:
- The candidate must be a regular student enrolled in recognized government / aided schools.
- Minimum Academic Qualification: 55% marks or equivalent grade in Class VII annual examination.
- Parental Annual Income: Total annual income from all sources must not exceed Rs. 2,50,000.
- Students studying in Kendriya Vidyalayas and Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalayas are NOT eligible.

4. REQUIRED CERTIFICATES & DOCUMENTS:
- Verified Income Certificate issued by Revenue Authority (Tahsildar/MRO) dated after April 2026.
- Class VII Annual Exam Marksheet certified by School Principal.
- Student Aadhaar Card copy (or Aadhaar Enrolment Slip).
- Caste / Category Certificate (SC/ST/OBC), if applicable.
- Bank Account Passbook (active account linked with Aadhaar in student name).
- Recent passport-sized color photograph (3.5 cm x 4.5 cm).

5. FINANCIAL BENEFIT & APPLICATION FEE:
- Scholarship Amount: Rs. 12,000 per annum (Rs. 1,000 per month).
- Application Processing Fee: NIL (Application is completely free of charge).

6. HOW TO APPLY (STEP-BY-STEP):
Step 1: Register on the National Scholarship Portal (scholarships.gov.in).
Step 2: Fill in personal, educational, and bank details accurately.
Step 3: Upload scanned copies of required certificates (PDF/JPEG max 200KB).
Step 4: Submit application and submit printed copy to School Principal.

7. WARNINGS & CONSEQUENCES OF FALSE INFORMATION:
- Submission of forged income or caste certificates will lead to immediate cancellation and recovery of disbursed amounts along with legal action under IPC Section 420.
- Late applications submitted after November 30, 2026 will be rejected automatically.
- NOTE: Hostel allowance and private tuition fees are NOT covered under this scheme.